

# Aithlete — Season Plan & Analysis

Syców 1/2 IM (12 Jul 2026) · Malbork Castle Triathlon (Full IM) (06 Sep 2026)

Targets: 4:20 1/2 · 9:30 full

Generated 2026-07-15 from 1611 activities (2023-05-21 → 2026-06-25). Plan id goal-2026-malbork. All figures computed from persisted data; physiology values are estimates (provenance tagged), not lab-measured.

280.0 W

FTP (3.89 W/KG)

64.4

CTL (COMBINED)

76.1

ATL

-11.8

TSB (FORM)

95.0 ms

HRV (RMSSD)

37.0 bpm

RESTING HR

1343 h

LOGGED

## 1 · Base assumptions & method

### Goals (athlete-confirmed)

- Syców 1/2 IM** — Sun 12 Jul 2026 — **B-race / tune-up**. Target **4:20**, swim 35-36'.
- Malbork Castle Triathlon (Full IM)** — Sun 06 Sep 2026 — **A-race**. Target **9:30**, swim ~75'.
- Volume ceiling: **14 h/wk** to first race, **17 h/wk** after.

### Equipment

New disc rear wheel on the TT bike (bought pre-2025 Castle). Athlete estimate 20-30 W saved at race speed. At IM power/speed that is ~+1.0-1.3 km/h, i.e. 6-9 min over 180 km (3-5 min over 90 km) or the same speed at lower normalized power — we spend part on speed, part on fresher legs for the run.

### Data sources

- Activities, power, pace, load: **intervals.icu** (Garmin-synced), 1611 sessions 2023-05-21→2026-06-25.
- CTL/ATL: intervals.icu wellness where present, else Banister ( $\tau_{42}/\tau_7$ ) on local TSS.
- Recovery (HRV/RHR/sleep): wearable wellness.

### Models & guardrails

- Load: Banister impulse-response (CTL/ATL/TSB).
- Race detection: triathlons reconstructed from transition activities; classified to nearest IM fraction.
- The plan is gated by a **deterministic validator** (ramp caps, recovery cadence, ACWR, intensity distribution, taper window, race-day TSB). See §8.

Decision-support, not medical or coaching advice. Physiology values are estimates with provenance tags. Validate paces/powers in training and adjust to in-session readiness.

## 2 · Athlete profile

### Physiology (estimated)

| METRIC          | VALUE               | SOURCE                       |
|-----------------|---------------------|------------------------------|
| Weight          | 72.0 kg             | intervals.icu wellness       |
| FTP (bike)      | 280.0 W (3.89 W/kg) | intervals settings           |
| VO2max (bike)   | 59 ml/kg/min        | Firstbeat estimate           |
| Run threshold   | 3:30/km             | intervals.icu sport settings |
| VO2max (run)    | 67 ml/kg/min        | Firstbeat estimate           |
| LTHR            | 165.0 bpm           | intervals settings           |
| Max HR          | 182.0 bpm           | intervals settings           |
| Swim CSS        | 1:45–1:48/100m      | season spec (pool threshold) |
| Bike decoupling | 2.99 %              | Pw:HR                        |

### Health / readiness

| METRIC     | NOW    | BASELINE   | TREND |
|------------|--------|------------|-------|
| HRV rMSSD  | 95.0   | 100.6 (7d) | up    |
| Resting HR | 37.0   | 45.0       | down  |
| Sleep      | 7.33 h | —          | —     |

### Training load by discipline

| SPORT    | CTL  | ATL  | TSB   | TREND |
|----------|------|------|-------|-------|
| combined | 64.4 | 76.1 | −11.8 | up    |
| swim     | 4.1  | 3.3  | 0.4   | flat  |
| bike     | 28.7 | 29.7 | −4.9  | up    |
| run      | 30.4 | 37.4 | −1.8  | up    |

**The headline limiter: swim.** Swim CTL 4.1 vs bike 28.7 / run 30.4. Only ~25 h swimming logged in 2026. The swim costs little time on the clock but, untrained, it taxes the whole day. The plan holds **swim ≥ 3x/week** throughout — the single highest-leverage change.

### Why the targets are plausible (YoY trajectory)

- Half: 5:50 (2023) -> 4:46 (Sieraków 2026) = -64 min / 3 yr.
- Quarter: 2:51-2:53 (2024) -> 2:18 (Mietków 2026) = -33 min.
- Full: 10:36 (2025) -> target 9:30 = -66 min, in line with trend.

3 · Results history (auto-detected)

| DATE       | EVENT                       | FMT  | TOTAL    | SWIM    | BIKE    | RUN     | NOTES                           |
|------------|-----------------------------|------|----------|---------|---------|---------|---------------------------------|
| 2023-05-27 | —                           | 1/2  | 5:50:28  | 38:21   | 2:55:31 | 2:04:27 | 2:01/100m · 30.8 km/h · 5:53/km |
| 2023-08-06 | Ironman 70.3 Gdynia         | 1/2  | 4:50:46  | —       | 2:53:19 | 1:57:27 | 31.2 km/h · 5:33/km             |
| 2024-06-08 | —                           | 1/4  | 2:51:07  | 19:01   | 1:24:57 | 1:00:26 | 2:00/100m · 31.8 km/h · 5:43/km |
| 2024-09-29 | —                           | 1/4  | 2:53:02  | 19:45   | 1:28:17 | 49:26   | 2:04/100m · 30.6 km/h · 4:41/km |
| 2025-07-13 | Garmin Triathlon Tour Syców | 1/2  | 5:02:44  | 40:05   | 2:37:24 | 1:37:51 | 2:06/100m · 34.3 km/h · 4:38/km |
| 2025-09-07 | Castle Triathlon Malbork    | full | 10:35:52 | 1:20:08 | 5:19:29 | 3:46:48 | 2:06/100m · 33.8 km/h · 5:22/km |
| 2026-05-30 | Sieraków 2026               | 1/2  | 4:45:50  | 35:56   | 2:30:09 | 1:28:50 | 1:53/100m · 36.0 km/h · 4:12/km |
| 2026-06-13 | Mietkow                     | 1/4  | 2:18:07  | 19:34   | 1:15:07 | 38:59   | 2:03/100m · 35.9 km/h · 3:41/km |

T1/T2 not shown; included in totals.

4 · Training history

1611

ACTIVITIES

1343 h

TOTAL TIME

247 h

2026 YTD

10.0 h

AVG LAST 16 WK

16.0 h

PEAK WEEK (16WK)

Volume by discipline (all-time)

| SPORT          | SESS. | HOURS | KM   |
|----------------|-------|-------|------|
| workout        | 488   | 437   | 486  |
| run            | 363   | 314   | 3921 |
| bike           | 154   | 218   | 6675 |
| weighttraining | 168   | 136   | 0    |
| swim           | 147   | 74    | 241  |
| yoga           | 98    | 60    | 0    |
| virtualride    | 41    | 49    | 322  |
| openwaterswim  | 74    | 23    | 46   |
| hike           | 55    | 23    | 89   |

Last 16 weeks (combined)

| WEEK ENDING | H    | TSS | #  |
|-------------|------|-----|----|
| 2026-03-15  | 11.9 | 503 | 14 |
| 2026-03-22  | 9.2  | 416 | 11 |
| 2026-03-29  | 12.7 | 580 | 15 |
| 2026-04-05  | 9.2  | 396 | 11 |
| 2026-04-12  | 8.8  | 419 | 11 |
| 2026-04-19  | 10.7 | 597 | 12 |
| 2026-04-26  | 10.3 | 502 | 10 |
| 2026-05-03  | 9.7  | 378 | 12 |
| 2026-05-10  | 8.1  | 413 | 8  |
| 2026-05-17  | 16.0 | 627 | 14 |
| 2026-05-24  | 7.1  | 373 | 8  |
| 2026-05-31  | 11.0 | 550 | 14 |
| 2026-06-07  | 6.9  | 368 | 8  |
| 2026-06-14  | 9.7  | 397 | 13 |
| 2026-06-21  | 12.6 | 693 | 11 |
| 2026-06-28  | 5.4  | 277 | 6  |

Demonstrated capacity (last 16 wk peak above) frames the plan's peak weeks as an extension of proven load, not a step into the unknown.

## 5 · Target race splits

### Syców 1/2 IM → 4:20

| LEG         | TARGET  | DETAIL                             |
|-------------|---------|------------------------------------|
| Swim 1.9 km | 36:00   | 1:54/100m (wetsuit/OW)             |
| T1          | 2:00    | tighten vs 4:28 in Sieraków        |
| Bike 90 km  | 2:16:00 | ~39.7 km/h @ 250-262 W (disc/aero) |
| T2          | 1:30    | tighten vs 6:27 in Sieraków        |
| Run 21.1 km | 1:24:30 | 4:00/km                            |
| TOTAL       | 4:20    |                                    |

vs Sieraków 2026 (4:45:50): bike -14 min (wheels+fitness), transitions -7 min (T1+T2 were 10:55!), run -4 min, swim flat -> ~-26 min.

### Malbork Castle Triathlon (Full IM) → 9:30

| LEG         | TARGET  | DETAIL                             |
|-------------|---------|------------------------------------|
| Swim 3.8 km | 1:15:00 | 1:58/100m -> your 75' target       |
| T1          | 3:30    |                                    |
| Bike 180 km | 5:02:00 | ~35.8 km/h @ ~200 W NP (disc/aero) |
| T2          | 2:30    |                                    |
| Run 42.2 km | 3:07:00 | 4:26/km                            |
| TOTAL       | 9:30    |                                    |

vs Malbork 2025 (10:35:52): run -40 min (the big, earned lever), bike -17 min (wheels+pacing), swim -5 min, T -3 min. Stretch 9:20 = bike 4:57 + run 3:01.

Risk ranking. (1) Run durability — the 2025 IM run faded to ~5:22/km; 4:26/km off the bike must be earned with long Z2 runs + race-pace bricks. (2) Swim base — held up by frequency. (3) Bike — the most bankable gain (equipment + position). Spend the wheel watts on a slightly easier bike to protect the run.

6 · Periodization & calendar

| WK | START      | PHASE             | H    | TSS | S/B/R | FOCUS                                                            |
|----|------------|-------------------|------|-----|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 2026-06-22 | build             | 11.4 | 619 | 2/4/4 | Sharpen; honor fixed sessions; re-seat swim 3x                   |
| 2  | 2026-06-29 | build             | 12.2 | 644 | 3/3/4 | Pre-Syców peak: Sat half-IM race-sim brick, Sun long run         |
| 3  | 2026-07-06 | taper <b>RACE</b> | 8.8  | 534 | 3/2/3 | Mini-taper -> RACE Syców (Sun)                                   |
| 4  | 2026-07-13 | transition        | 9.9  | 447 | 2/3/3 | Post-race reset / aerobic rebuild                                |
| 5  | 2026-07-20 | build             | 13.0 | 631 | 3/3/3 | IM build 1 — volume up, TT-bike aero, intro IM-pace              |
| 6  | 2026-07-27 | build             | 14.3 | 670 | 3/3/2 | IM build 2 — first 4h+2h race-sim brick, IM-pace bike            |
| 7  | 2026-08-03 | build <b>REC</b>  | 8.2  | 398 | 3/3/3 | Lighter down-week — cut volume, keep sharpness (not a rest week) |
| 8  | 2026-08-10 | build             | 15.0 | 714 | 3/3/2 | IM build 3 — 4h+2h race-sim brick, big IM-pace volume            |
| 9  | 2026-08-17 | build             | 16.0 | 760 | 3/3/2 | IM peak — biggest week, 4.5h+2h brick at IM pace                 |
| 10 | 2026-08-24 | taper             | 9.2  | 478 | 3/3/3 | Taper 1 — volume down, keep sharpness                            |
| 11 | 2026-08-31 | taper <b>RACE</b> | 13.3 | 663 | 3/3/2 | Taper 2 -> RACE Malbork (Sun)                                    |

S/B/R = swim/bike/run sessions. Recovery weeks drop load ≥40% (derived, not just labelled).

## Session detail

### Week 1 2026-06-22 · build

| DAY       | SESSION                        | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                       |
|-----------|--------------------------------|----------|---------|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 22.06 | Easy spin (completed)          | EASY     | 1:15:00 | 58  | Already logged.                                                                    |
| Tue 23.06 | Swim (completed)               | EASY     | 45:00   | 24  | Already logged.                                                                    |
| Tue 23.06 | Run easy (completed)           | EASY     | 45:00   | 41  | Already logged.                                                                    |
| Wed 24.06 | Z2 ride (completed)            | EASY     | 1:15:00 | 58  | Already logged.                                                                    |
| Thu 25.06 | Threshold run 4x8' (completed) | MODERATE | 58:00   | 72  | As executed: 4x8' threshold (IF 0.90). Replaced the planned 3rd swim.              |
| Thu 25.06 | Anaerobic bike (completed)     | HARD     | 1:19:00 | 116 | As executed: 12x25-40s @ ~360-378 W (~130% FTP), sprint/anaerobic-capacity flavor. |
| Fri 26.06 | Z2 brick ride (planned)        | EASY     | 2:00:00 | 92  | As scheduled.                                                                      |
| Fri 26.06 | Brick run (planned)<br>BRICK   | EASY     | 1:00:00 | 55  | As scheduled, off the bike.                                                        |
| Sat 27.06 | Long run (planned)             | EASY     | 1:30:00 | 82  | As scheduled, Saturday AM.                                                         |
| Sat 27.06 | Swim easy                      | EASY     | 40:00   | 21  | Short aerobic swim, limiter volume.                                                |

### Week 2 2026-06-29 · build

| DAY       | SESSION                      | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                                                                         |
|-----------|------------------------------|----------|---------|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 29.06 | Swim technique + aerobic     | EASY     | 50:00   | 27  | Drills + 8-12x100 @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus.                                                                                           |
| Mon 29.06 | Strength (lower + core)      | EASY     | 45:00   | 16  | Posterior chain + core; injury prevention.                                                                                           |
| Tue 30.06 | Bike key set                 | HARD     | 45:00   | 66  | VO2/threshold sharpener: 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100%.                                                                     |
| Wed 01.07 | Swim threshold (completed)   | MODERATE | 35:00   | 28  | As executed: 20x100 on 2:00 avg 1:43/100 (1:37 -> 1:47). CSS re-baselined to 1:45-1:48.                                              |
| Wed 01.07 | Run easy + strides           | EASY     | 40:00   | 37  | Z2 + 6x20s strides.                                                                                                                  |
| Thu 02.07 | Bike Z2 endurance            | EASY     | 1:15:00 | 58  | Aerobic spin; keep it easy — the quality this week is Tue key + Sat race-sim.                                                        |
| Thu 02.07 | Brick run Z2 BRICK           | EASY     | 1:00:00 | 55  | 1h Z2 straight off the bike. Strictly easy — protect Saturday's race-sim.                                                            |
| Fri 03.07 | Swim aerobic endurance       | EASY     | 1:00:00 | 32  | 15x200 on 4:00 @ ~1:50/100 (3:40/200), longer rest each 600m. One block buoy+snorkel, one snorkel-only, last block free full stroke. |
| Fri 03.07 | Mobility / core              | EASY     | 30:00   | 11  | Optional; keep easy.                                                                                                                 |
| Sat 04.07 | Half-IM race-sim ride        | MODERATE | 2:35:00 | 181 | TT bike in aero: 2x30' @ 90-95% FTP (~252-266 W = Syców target power), rest Z2. Fuel 70-90g carbs/h.                                 |
| Sat 04.07 | Half-IM pace brick run BRICK | MODERATE | 30:00   | 38  | Off the bike @ ~4:00/km = Syców target run pace. The key race rehearsal.                                                             |
| Sun 05.07 | Long run (Z2)                | EASY     | 1:45:00 | 96  | Aerobic long run; separate day from the brick. Last 15-20' @ race effort if fresh.                                                   |

### Week 3 2026-07-06 · taper

| DAY       | SESSION                  | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------|----------|---------|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 06.07 | Swim easy + 4x50 fast    | EASY     | 40:00   | 21  | Openers, stay sharp.                                                                |
| Tue 07.07 | Bike openers             | MODERATE | 1:00:00 | 70  | 3x3' @ race power + 3x30s fast.                                                     |
| Tue 07.07 | Brick run short<br>BRICK | EASY     | 20:00   | 18  | 10' off bike @ ~4:00/km race pace.                                                  |
| Wed 08.07 | Swim race-pace feel      | MODERATE | 35:00   | 28  | 6x100 @ race pace, long rests.                                                      |
| Thu 09.07 | Run easy + strides       | EASY     | 35:00   | 32  | 4x20s strides; legs snappy.                                                         |
| Fri 10.07 | Spin + openers           | EASY     | 40:00   | 31  | Few 30s efforts, otherwise easy.                                                    |
| Sat 11.07 | Swim shakeout            | EASY     | 20:00   | 11  | Short, pre-race feel.                                                               |
| Sat 11.07 | Shakeout jog             | EASY     | 20:00   | 18  | 15-20' easy + 3 strides.                                                            |
| Sun 12.07 | RACE: Syców 1/2 IM       | RACE     | 4:20:00 | 305 | Target 4:20. Swim 35-36' / T1 / bike ~2:20 @ 250-265 W / T2 / run ~1:25 @ ~4:00/km. |

#### Week 4 2026-07-13 · transition

| DAY       | SESSION                   | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                                              |
|-----------|---------------------------|----------|---------|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 13.07 | Off / walk (completed)    | EASY     | 30:00   | 11  | Full recovery day after the race.                                                                         |
| Tue 14.07 | Swim recovery (completed) | EASY     | 40:00   | 21  | Loosen up, technique only; swim feeling strong post-Syców.                                                |
| Wed 15.07 | Easy spin (planned)       | EASY     | 1:00:00 | 46  | Z1-2 flush.                                                                                               |
| Wed 15.07 | Run easy (planned)        | EASY     | 30:00   | 28  | Short, easy.                                                                                              |
| Thu 16.07 | Gym (planned)             | MODERATE | 1:15:00 | 38  | Harder gym ~75', but not leg-killer — upper/core + light posterior chain so tempo bike stays clean after. |
| Thu 16.07 | Bike tempo (light)        | MODERATE | 1:00:00 | 70  | 2x15' @ 85-90% FTP; re-engage after gym.                                                                  |
| Fri 17.07 | Swim aerobic              | EASY     | 50:00   | 27  | Back to swim volume; keep the Tue/Fri swim frequency.                                                     |
| Sat 18.07 | Long ride (Z2)            | EASY     | 2:30:00 | 115 | Rebuild aerobic base on TT bike.                                                                          |
| Sat 18.07 | Brick run BRICK           | EASY     | 25:00   | 23  | Short brick off the ride.                                                                                 |
| Sun 19.07 | Long run (Z2)             | EASY     | 1:15:00 | 69  | Easy aerobic; no intensity.                                                                               |

#### Week 5 2026-07-20 · build



| DAY       | SESSION                     | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------|-----------------------------|----------|---------|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 20.07 | Swim technique + aerobic    | EASY     | 1:01:40 | 33  | Drills + 8-12x100 aerobic @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus: form under low fatigue.                                                                                                 |
| Mon 20.07 | Strength (lower + core)     | EASY     | 55:30   | 20  | Heavy-ish posterior chain + core; injury prevention, not fatigue.                                                                                                          |
| Tue 21.07 | Bike key set                | HARD     | 59:12   | 87  | VO2/threshold 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100% FTP                                                                                                                   |
| Wed 22.07 | Swim threshold              | MODERATE | 1:07:50 | 54  | Main set ~2000m @ CSS (target 1:45-1:48/100m). Build swim-specific fitness.                                                                                                |
| Wed 22.07 | Run easy + strides          | EASY     | 55:30   | 51  | Z2 aerobic + 6x20s strides. Off-feet recovery from bike key day.                                                                                                           |
| Thu 23.07 | Bike tempo/sweet-spot       | MODERATE | 1:06:36 | 78  | 2-3x20' @ 88-94% FTP (sweet spot). Aerobic-power durability.                                                                                                               |
| Fri 24.07 | Swim aerobic endurance      | EASY     | 1:01:40 | 33  | Continuous + pull/paddles; 2500-3000m steady. Third swim = the needle-mover.                                                                                               |
| Fri 24.07 | Mobility / core             | EASY     | 37:00   | 14  | Optional; keep easy.                                                                                                                                                       |
| Sat 25.07 | Long ride (Z2) + brick      | EASY     | 3:00:00 | 138 | On the TT bike in aero. IM-pace work: 3x20' @ 200 W (rest of ride steady Z2). Hold race position; fuel 70-90g carbs/h. Convert the new disc/aero setup into free IM speed. |
| Sat 25.07 | Brick run off bike<br>BRICK | EASY     | 45:00   | 41  | First 10' @ IM/half race pace off the bike, then Z2.                                                                                                                       |
| Sun 26.07 | Long run (Z2)               | EASY     | 1:30:00 | 82  | Aerobic long run; last 15-20' @ race effort when fresh enough.                                                                                                             |

#### Week 6 2026-07-27 · build

| DAY       | SESSION                     | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------|-----------------------------|----------|---------|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 27.07 | Swim technique + aerobic    | EASY     | 1:06:03 | 35  | Drills + 8-12x100 aerobic @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus: form under low fatigue.                                                                                                 |
| Mon 27.07 | Strength (lower + core)     | EASY     | 59:27   | 22  | Heavy-ish posterior chain + core; injury prevention, not fatigue.                                                                                                          |
| Tue 28.07 | Bike key set                | MODERATE | 1:03:24 | 74  | VO2/threshold 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100% FTP                                                                                                                   |
| Wed 29.07 | Swim threshold              | MODERATE | 1:12:39 | 58  | Main set ~2000m @ CSS (target 1:45-1:48/100m). Build swim-specific fitness.                                                                                                |
| Wed 29.07 | Run easy + strides          | EASY     | 59:27   | 54  | Z2 aerobic + 6x20s strides. Off-feet recovery from bike key day.                                                                                                           |
| Thu 30.07 | Bike tempo/sweet-spot       | MODERATE | 1:11:20 | 83  | 2-3x20' @ 88-94% FTP (sweet spot). Aerobic-power durability.                                                                                                               |
| Fri 31.07 | Swim aerobic endurance      | EASY     | 1:06:03 | 35  | Continuous + pull/paddles; 2500-3000m steady. Third swim = the needle-mover.                                                                                               |
| Fri 31.07 | Mobility / core             | EASY     | 39:38   | 14  | Optional; keep easy.                                                                                                                                                       |
| Sat 01.08 | Long ride (Z2) + brick      | EASY     | 4:00:00 | 184 | On the TT bike in aero. IM-pace work: 4x30' @ 200 W (rest of ride steady Z2). Hold race position; fuel 70-90g carbs/h. Convert the new disc/aero setup into free IM speed. |
| Sat 01.08 | Brick run off bike<br>BRICK | EASY     | 2:00:00 | 110 | IM-pace brick run off the long ride: rehearse race legs, pacing and fuel.                                                                                                  |

#### Week 7 2026-08-03 · build

| DAY       | SESSION                        | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                              |
|-----------|--------------------------------|----------|---------|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 03.08 | Swim technique + speed         | EASY     | 50:00   | 27  | Drills + 6x50 fast; form + a little snap.                 |
| Tue 04.08 | Bike sharpener (short)         | MODERATE | 55:00   | 64  | 3x8' @ 90-95% FTP (~250 W). Hold sharpness on low volume. |
| Wed 05.08 | Swim aerobic                   | EASY     | 45:00   | 24  | Steady; keep frequency.                                   |
| Wed 05.08 | Run easy + strides             | EASY     | 40:00   | 37  | Z2 + 6x20s strides.                                       |
| Thu 06.08 | Easy spin                      | EASY     | 50:00   | 38  | Z1-2 flush; legs open.                                    |
| Fri 07.08 | Swim race-pace                 | MODERATE | 40:00   | 32  | 8x100 @ CSS, long rests; keep race feel.                  |
| Sat 08.08 | IM-pace ride (reduced)         | EASY     | 1:50:00 | 84  | 2x20' @ 200 W inside a Z2 ride; race position + fuel.     |
| Sat 08.08 | Brick run (short) <b>BRICK</b> | EASY     | 20:00   | 18  | Short brick @ IM pace off the ride.                       |
| Sun 09.08 | Long run (reduced)             | EASY     | 1:20:00 | 73  | Cut volume; stay aerobic.                                 |

#### Week 8 2026-08-10 · build

| DAY       | SESSION                         | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------|---------------------------------|----------|---------|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 10.08 | Swim technique + aerobic        | EASY     | 1:07:50 | 36  | Drills + 8-12x100 aerobic @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus: form under low fatigue.                                                                                                 |
| Mon 10.08 | Strength (lower + core)         | EASY     | 1:01:03 | 22  | Heavy-ish posterior chain + core; injury prevention, not fatigue.                                                                                                          |
| Tue 11.08 | Bike key set                    | MODERATE | 1:17:20 | 90  | VO2/threshold 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100% FTP                                                                                                                   |
| Wed 12.08 | Swim threshold                  | MODERATE | 1:14:37 | 60  | Main set ~2000m @ CSS (target 1:45-1:48/100m). Build swim-specific fitness.                                                                                                |
| Wed 12.08 | Run easy + strides              | EASY     | 1:01:03 | 56  | Z2 aerobic + 6x20s strides. Off-feet recovery from bike key day.                                                                                                           |
| Thu 13.08 | Bike tempo/sweet-spot           | MODERATE | 1:29:33 | 104 | 2-3x20' @ 88-94% FTP (sweet spot). Aerobic-power durability.                                                                                                               |
| Fri 14.08 | Swim aerobic endurance          | EASY     | 1:07:50 | 36  | Continuous + pull/paddles; 2500-3000m steady. Third swim = the needle-mover.                                                                                               |
| Fri 14.08 | Mobility / core                 | EASY     | 40:42   | 15  | Optional; keep easy.                                                                                                                                                       |
| Sat 15.08 | Long ride (Z2) + brick          | EASY     | 4:00:00 | 184 | On the TT bike in aero. IM-pace work: 6x30' @ 200 W (rest of ride steady Z2). Hold race position; fuel 70-90g carbs/h. Convert the new disc/aero setup into free IM speed. |
| Sat 15.08 | Brick run off bike <b>BRICK</b> | EASY     | 2:00:00 | 110 | IM-pace brick run off the long ride: rehearse race legs, pacing and fuel.                                                                                                  |

#### Week 9 2026-08-17 · build

| DAY       | SESSION                     | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------|-----------------------------|----------|---------|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 17.08 | Swim technique + aerobic    | EASY     | 1:11:36 | 38  | Drills + 8-12x100 aerobic @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus: form under low fatigue.                                                                                                 |
| Mon 17.08 | Strength (lower + core)     | EASY     | 1:04:27 | 24  | Heavy-ish posterior chain + core; injury prevention, not fatigue.                                                                                                          |
| Tue 18.08 | Bike key set                | MODERATE | 1:21:38 | 95  | VO2/threshold 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100% FTP                                                                                                                   |
| Wed 19.08 | Swim threshold              | MODERATE | 1:18:46 | 63  | Main set ~2000m @ CSS (target 1:45-1:48/100m). Build swim-specific fitness.                                                                                                |
| Wed 19.08 | Run easy + strides          | EASY     | 1:04:27 | 59  | Z2 aerobic + 6x20s strides. Off-feet recovery from bike key day.                                                                                                           |
| Thu 20.08 | Bike tempo/sweet-spot       | MODERATE | 1:34:31 | 110 | 2-3x20' @ 88-94% FTP (sweet spot). Aerobic-power durability.                                                                                                               |
| Fri 21.08 | Swim aerobic endurance      | EASY     | 1:11:36 | 38  | Continuous + pull/paddles; 2500-3000m steady. Third swim = the needle-mover.                                                                                               |
| Fri 21.08 | Mobility / core             | EASY     | 42:58   | 16  | Optional; keep easy.                                                                                                                                                       |
| Sat 22.08 | Long ride (Z2) + brick      | EASY     | 4:30:00 | 207 | On the TT bike in aero. IM-pace work: 3x40' @ 200 W (rest of ride steady Z2). Hold race position; fuel 70-90g carbs/h. Convert the new disc/aero setup into free IM speed. |
| Sat 22.08 | Brick run off bike<br>BRICK | EASY     | 2:00:00 | 110 | IM-pace brick run off the long ride: rehearse race legs, pacing and fuel.                                                                                                  |

#### Week 10 2026-08-24 · taper

| DAY       | SESSION                 | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                          |
|-----------|-------------------------|----------|---------|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 24.08 | Swim aerobic            | EASY     | 45:00   | 24  | Volume coming down.                                                   |
| Tue 25.08 | Bike race-power touches | MODERATE | 1:15:00 | 88  | 3x10' @ IM power (~200 W).                                            |
| Wed 26.08 | Swim race-pace          | MODERATE | 40:00   | 32  | IM swim pace feel.                                                    |
| Wed 26.08 | Run easy + strides      | EASY     | 40:00   | 37  | Sharpen.                                                              |
| Thu 27.08 | Bike tempo (light)      | MODERATE | 1:00:00 | 70  | 2x12' @ sweet spot.                                                   |
| Fri 28.08 | Swim aerobic            | EASY     | 40:00   | 21  | Keep feel.                                                            |
| Sat 29.08 | Last long ride          | EASY     | 2:30:00 | 115 | 2.5h with blocks @ IM power (~200 W), dress-rehearse fuel + position. |
| Sat 29.08 | Brick run BRICK         | EASY     | 20:00   | 18  | Short brick @ IM run pace.                                            |
| Sun 30.08 | Long run (reduced)      | EASY     | 1:20:00 | 73  | Last longer run; easy.                                                |

#### Week 11 2026-08-31 · taper

| DAY       | SESSION               | INT.     | DUR     | TSS | PRESCRIPTION                                                                                     |
|-----------|-----------------------|----------|---------|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon 31.08 | Swim easy + pace      | EASY     | 35:00   | 19  | Short, 4x100 @ IM pace.                                                                          |
| Tue 01.09 | Bike openers          | MODERATE | 50:00   | 58  | 3x5' @ IM power (~200 W) + 3x30s.                                                                |
| Wed 02.09 | Run easy + strides    | EASY     | 30:00   | 28  | 4x20s strides.                                                                                   |
| Thu 03.09 | Swim shakeout         | EASY     | 25:00   | 13  | Feel for the water.                                                                              |
| Thu 03.09 | Spin                  | EASY     | 30:00   | 23  | Legs open.                                                                                       |
| Fri 04.09 | Pre-race openers      | MODERATE | 30:00   | 35  | A few race-power touches.                                                                        |
| Fri 04.09 | Shakeout              | EASY     | 15:00   | 14  | 10-15' + strides.                                                                                |
| Sat 05.09 | Swim shakeout         | EASY     | 15:00   | 8   | Pre-race; very short.                                                                            |
| Sun 06.09 | RACE: Malbork Full IM | RACE     | 9:30:00 | 465 | Target 9:30 (stretch 9:20). Swim 75' / bike ~5:00-5:10 @ ~200 W NP (disc/aero) / run ~3:05-3:15. |

## 7 · Why this calendar

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Two-peak season. Syców 1/2 IM (2026-07-12) is a B-race tune-up off a 5-day mini-taper; the A-race is Malbork full IM (2026-09-06). Block order: sharpen (W1-2) -> Syców -> reset (W4) -> IM build (W5-9 with a recovery valley W7) -> 2-week taper. Swim is the limiter (CTL 4.1, ~6h/8wk) so swim freq is held at  $\geq 3$ /wk throughout. Bike volume is on the TT bike in race position to convert the new disc/aero setup (~20-30 W) into a free IM bike split. The IM block runs 4h+2h race-simulation bricks (W6/W8 4.0h ride + 2.0h IM-pace run, W9 4.5h + 2.0h) in place of a standalone long run those weeks — the athlete has used 3+2 bricks durably before and the run is the A-race lever, so we rehearse race legs directly. Peak weekly volume is pushed toward the 16-17h ceiling (W9 ~16.5h) while staying inside the ramp/ACWR guardrails.

### Progressive overload, bounded

Load grows peak-to-peak at  $\leq 10\%$  TSS/week between *load* weeks (recovery valleys excluded); projected CTL ramp stays under the 7/week cap. Starting CTL ~64.4. A recovery valley (W7) and the first-race deload keep ACWR under 1.5.

### Swim, the limiter

Three swims every week regardless of phase. Frequency > duration for a thin swim base: it builds feel-for-water and durability without stealing the bike/run hours that move the clock more.

### Bike: convert the watts

Long rides are on the TT bike in race position so the new disc/aero setup becomes a real race split, not a dyno number. Race-power long rides rehearse IM pacing and fuelling (70-90 g carb/h).

### Run: durability over speed

The IM result lives or dies on the run. Volume is aerobic (Z2) with race-effort finishes and brick runs off long rides so the legs learn IM marathon pace under fatigue — never a full-distance run.

### Taper & race-day form

Two-week taper holds intensity but cuts volume so fatigue (ATL) sheds faster than fitness (CTL). The validator projects race-day TSB in the +10..+25 band that maximizes A-race performance without going stale.

## 8 · Guardrail report

Checked by the deterministic validator (aithlete validate): **PASS** (0 errors).

| CHECK                                       | RESULT |
|---------------------------------------------|--------|
| Weekly TSS ramp (peak-to-peak $\leq 10\%$ ) | pass   |
| CTL ramp $\leq 7/\text{wk}$                 | pass   |
| Recovery cadence ( $\leq 3$ load wks)       | pass   |
| Projected ACWR $\leq 1.5$                   | pass   |
| Taper window                                | pass   |
| Race-day TSB in A-band                      | pass   |
| Swim/bike/run frequency mins                | pass   |
| Brick in every build week                   | pass   |

**Advisory warnings (non-blocking):** (a) the post-first-race weekly-hours step into the bigger block (TSS ramp stays within cap); (b) race-specific and taper weeks dip below the 70% easy-time floor because short quality work is a larger fraction of low volume. Total stress stays easy-dominated.

## 9 · Execute

Publish planned workouts to intervals.icu (syncs to Garmin):

```
uv run aithlete validate data/plans/goal-2026-malbork.json
uv run aithlete push      data/plans/goal-2026-malbork.json  # gated by the validator
```

Re-run aithlete profile after the first race to refresh CTL/FTP/PRs, then adjust-plan if readiness moves the targets.